

Option 31: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39

Key topic 1: The Weimar Republic 1918–29

1 The origins of the Republic, 1918–19	- The situation in Germany at the end of the War: political unrest, abdication of the Kaiser, armistice and new republic. - The strengths and weaknesses of the new Weimar Constitution.
2 The early challenges to the Weimar Republic, 1919–23	- Reasons for the early unpopularity of the Republic, including the 'stab in the back' theory and the key terms of the Treaty of Versailles. - Challenges to the Republic from Left and Right: Spartacists, Freikorps, the Kapp Putsch. - The challenges of 1923: hyperinflation; the reasons for, and effects of, the French occupation of the Ruhr.
3 The 'Golden Years': recovery of the Republic, 1924–29	- Reasons for economic recovery, including the work of Stresemann, the Rentenmark, the Dawes and Young Plans and American loans and investment. - Stresemann's achievements in gaining international acceptance of Germany abroad through the Locarno Pact and joining the League of Nations.
4 Changes in society, 1924–29	- Changes in the standard of living. - Changes in the position of women in work, politics and leisure. - Cultural changes: developments in architecture, art and the cinema.

Key topic 2: Hitler's rise to power, 1919–33

1 Early development of the Nazi Party, 1920–22	- Hitler's early career: joining the German Workers' Party and setting up the Nazi Party, 1919–20. - The Twenty-Five Point Programme. The role of the SA.
2 The Munich Putsch and the Nazi Party, 1923–28	- The reasons for, events and consequences of the Munich Putsch; <i>Mein Kampf</i>. - Reasons for limited support for the Nazi Party, 1924–28. Party reorganisation, including the Bamberg Conference of 1926.
3 The growth in support for the Nazis, 1929–32	- The growth of unemployment – its causes and impact. The growth of support for the Communist Party. - Reasons for the growth in support for the Nazi Party, including the appeal of Hitler and the Nazis, the effects of propaganda and the work of the SA.
4 How Hitler became Chancellor, 1932–33	The Presidential and Reichstag elections of 1932; reasons for Hitler becoming Chancellor in 1933, including the roles of Hindenburg and von Papen.

Key topic 3: Nazi control and dictatorship, 1933–39

1 The creation of a dictatorship, 1933–34	• The Reichstag Fire. The Enabling Act and the banning of other parties and trade unions. • The threat from Röhm and the SA, the Night of the Long Knives. The death of Hindenburg. Hitler becomes Führer, the army oath of allegiance.
2 The police state	• The role of the Gestapo, the SS and concentration camps. • Nazi control of the legal system.
3 Controlling and influencing attitudes	• Goebbels and the Ministry of Propaganda: censorship, Nazi use of media, rallies and sport, including the Berlin Olympics (1936). • Nazi control of culture and the arts, including art, architecture, literature and film. • Nazi attempts to control the Catholic and Protestant Churches: the Concordat and the Reich Church.
4 Opposition, resistance and conformity	• The extent of support for the Nazi regime. • Opposition from the Churches, including the role of Pastor Niemöller. • Opposition from the young, including the Swing Youth and the Edelweiss Pirates.

Key topic 4: Life in Nazi Germany, 1933–39

1 Nazi policies towards women	• Nazi views on women and the family. • Nazi policies towards women, including marriage and family, employment and appearance.
2 Nazi policies towards the young	• Nazi aims and policies towards the young. The Hitler Youth and the League of German Maidens. • Nazi control of the young through education, including the curriculum and teachers.
3 Employment and living standards	• Nazi policies to reduce unemployment: labour service, autobahns, rearmament and invisible unemployment. • Changes in the standard of living, especially of German workers. The Labour Front, Strength Through Joy, Beauty of Labour.
4 The persecution of minorities	• Nazi racial beliefs and policies and the treatment of minority groups: Slavs, Roma and Sinti, homosexuals, and people with disabilities. • The persecution of Jewish people, including the boycott of Jewish shops and businesses (1933), the Nuremberg Laws and 'Kristallnacht'.